

IT Recruitment Training Manual – UK Market

1. Introduction

Welcome to the IT Recruitment team! This manual is designed to help new joiners understand the UK IT recruitment landscape, processes, tools, compliance requirements, and best practices. It will act as your go-to reference during your onboarding period and throughout your recruiting journey.

2. Understanding the UK IT Recruitment Market

2.1 Key Sectors in IT

- 🎬 Software Development (Java, .NET, Python, JavaScript)
- 🎬 Cloud & DevOps (AWS, Azure, GCP)
- 🎬 Cybersecurity
- 🎬 Data & Analytics (Data Engineers, Data Scientists)
- 🎬 Infrastructure & Networks
- 🎬 ERP & CRM (SAP, Oracle, Salesforce)
- 🎬 Product & Project Management
- 🎬 QA & Testing

2.2 Contract vs Permanent Hiring in the UK

🎬 Contract Roles

- Usually hired for short-term projects (3–12 months)
- IR35 regulations apply (very important)
- Faster hiring cycle

🎬 Permanent Roles

- Long-term employees
- Notice periods typically 1–3 months
- Company benefits are part of attraction strategy

2.3 Understanding Job Levels

- 🎬 Junior / Entry-level
- 🎬 Mid-level
- 🎬 Senior / Lead
- 🎬 Manager / Principal / Architect
- 🎬 Director / Head of IT / CTO

3. Recruitment Lifecycle in the UK IT Market

3.1 Intake Call / Job Qualification

- 🎬 Gather job requirements
- 🎬 Understand tech stack clearly
- 🎬 Ask about team structure
- 🎬 Assess urgency & hiring timeline

- Understand budget & salary/contract rate expectations

3.2 Sourcing Candidates

Key sourcing channels: - LinkedIn Recruiter - Job boards (Indeed, CWJobs, Totaljobs, Jobserve) - Internal database / CRM - Referrals - GitHub, StackOverflow (for developers)

3.3 Screening Candidates

During your call, assess: - Technical skills match - Communication skills - UK work authorization (visa requirements) - Current & expected salary/rate - Notice period - Reason for job change

3.4 Shortlisting & Submission

- Provide formatted CV
- Add candidate summary
- Highlight technical fit & key skills
- Check alignment with client job specs

3.5 Interview Management

- Schedule interviews with hiring managers
- Prepare candidates (interview format, expectations)
- Follow-up after interviews

3.6 Offer & Negotiation

- Discuss salary/rate expectations upfront
- Confirm holiday/benefits (permanent roles)
- For contractors, clarify IR35 status
- Manage counteroffers

3.7 Onboarding

- Share onboarding documents
- Confirm start date
- Maintain contact until Day 1

4. Technical Knowledge for IT Recruiters

4.1 Popular Technologies & What They Mean

- **Frontend:** React, Angular, Vue
- **Backend:** Java, C#, Node.js, Python
- **Databases:** SQL Server, MySQL, MongoDB, PostgreSQL
- **Cloud:** AWS, Azure, GCP
- **DevOps Tools:** Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins
- **Testing:** Selenium, Cypress, Manual QA

4.2 Understanding Job Descriptions

Learn to break down: - Must-have skills - Good-to-have skills - Responsibilities - Team/environment - Seniority level

5. Compliance & Legal Requirements (UK)

5.1 Right to Work Checks

Candidates must have: - UK passport or residence permit - Skilled Worker Visa - Pre-settled / Settled Status

5.2 IR35 for Contractors

Key points: - Determines if contractor is inside or outside IR35 - Impacts tax and pay structure - Important for contract negotiations

5.3 GDPR Compliance

- Always get consent before storing CVs
- Do not share personal data without permission
- Use secure channels for documents

6. Boolean Search Techniques

Examples:

(Java OR "Java Developer" OR "Backend Developer") AND (Spring OR Springboot) AND (AWS)

6.1 Tips for Effective Boolean Searches

- Use job titles + skills
- Include synonyms (e.g., DevOps / SRE)
- Exclude unrelated skills using NOT

7. Communication Skills

7.1 Candidate Communication

- Be clear and concise
- Share job details transparently
- Avoid overpromising
- Keep candidates informed at all stages

7.2 Client Communication

- Understand business needs
- Manage expectations
- Provide timely updates
- Gain credibility by sharing market insights

8. KPIs and Performance Metrics

- Number of CV submissions
- Shortlists

- 🎬 Interviews scheduled
- 🎬 Offers made
- 🎬 Placements (contract & permanent)
- 🎬 Time-to-fill metrics

9. Tools & Systems

- 🎬 Applicant Tracking System (ATS)
- 🎬 LinkedIn Recruiter
- 🎬 Job board databases
- 🎬 CRM systems
- 🎬 Email templates
- 🎬 Microsoft Teams / Zoom (client calls)

10. Best Practices for Success in UK IT Recruitment

- 🎬 Learn tech stacks continuously
- 🎬 Follow market trends (AI, cloud, security)
- 🎬 Build strong candidate pipelines
- 🎬 Treat clients and candidates as partners
- 🎬 Maintain excellent documentation

11. Sample Scripts

11.1 Candidate Outreach Template

“Hi [Name], I came across your profile and thought your experience with [skill] stood out. I’m working on a role for [Company/Role], and your background seems like a strong match. Would you be open to a quick chat?”

11.2 Intake Call Script

- 🎬 What are the must-have skills?
- 🎬 What projects will they work on?
- 🎬 What’s the team structure?
- 🎬 What’s the budget and timeline?
- 🎬 Why is this role open?

12. Glossary for New Recruiters

- 🎬 **IR35** – UK tax legislation for contractors
- 🎬 **JD** – Job Description
- 🎬 **ATS** – Applicant Tracking System
- 🎬 **SOW** – Statement of Work
- 🎬 **Skill Matrix** – Table comparing skills vs. job requirements

13. Conclusion

This manual provides a complete overview to help you begin your journey as an IT Recruiter in the UK market. As you gain experience, you will get better at understanding roles, managing clients, and sourcing exceptional talent.

Welcome to the team!